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FOREWORD

The history of citizen soldiery in Canada stretches back centuries, predating even Confederation. Throughout the country's history, local inhabitants played a vital role in defending their communities. This tradition of citizen soldiers continued to evolve, culminating in the formation of the modern Canadian Army Reserve in the 19th century.

Today, the Reserve Force serves as an integral component of the Canadian Armed Forces (CAF), providing critical operational support in times of crisis or need. While a part-time service, the Army Reserve, as a vital part of the Army, generates full-time capabilities allowing members to choose to serve either from home or abroad.



For Hearth and Home, 31 Canadian Brigade Group

Established in 1994, 31 Canadian Brigade Group (31CBG) boasts a rich history of service, contributing to both domestic and international operations. As an Army Reserve Formation headquartered in London, the Brigade area of responsibility reaches across southwestern Ontario.

In recent years, the Brigade has deployed hundreds of soldiers to overseas operations in Afghanistan, Iraq, the Democratic Republic of Congo, the UK and Eastern Europe. Domestically, the Brigade has also supported and provided personnel to civilian authorities during times of crisis, such as supporting civilian authorities during the Covid-19 pandemic. From rendering vital assistance during local disasters to deploying with distinction on international missions, 31 CBG exemplifies the unwavering dedication and professionalism that defines Canada's citizen soldiers.

This magazine seeks to recognize the rich history of the Brigade, highlight its current operations and activities, celebrate members successes and to overall demonstrate 31 CBG's commitment to the defense of Canada and of all Canadians. As 31 CBG continues its proud legacy of service, this journal will document our journey and inspire future generations of soldiers.

Dedicated to the soldiers of 31 CBG. Pro Aris et Focis.



Infantry regiments," he thought, "invite this kind of consideration; for an infantry regiment consists of little except human beings... The infantry regiment is the queen of battle; it is also the working man with an eternal chip on his shoulder and an indestructible core of cynicism and self-satisfaction."

- Claude Bissel (1916 to 2000), Canadian author and educator.